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TikTok merges its Core Product and Trust & Safety teams

As TikTok's [future in the U.S. remains uncertain](#), the company is merging its Core Product and Trust & Safety teams into a single organization, according to an internal memo sent to staff by TikTok CEO Shou Zi Chew and viewed by TechCrunch and confirmed by TikTok.

"This new team will allow us to better leverage our technical capabilities across both business and safety objectives, and will help us move faster as we develop the next generation of safety technology," Chew wrote in the memo.

As part of the changes, the memo said that TikTok's head of Operations and Trust & Safety, Adam Presser, will become the general manager of TikTok USDS, a separate entity of TikTok that's tasked with safeguarding U.S. national security interests, TikTok confirmed to TechCrunch.

Andy Bonillo, the current general manager of TikTok USDS, who led the organization's creation and growth, will transition to a new role as senior adviser, reporting to Presser.

The TikTok Operations teams will continue to report directly to Presser, while Sandeep Grover will become the new head of Global Trust & Safety.

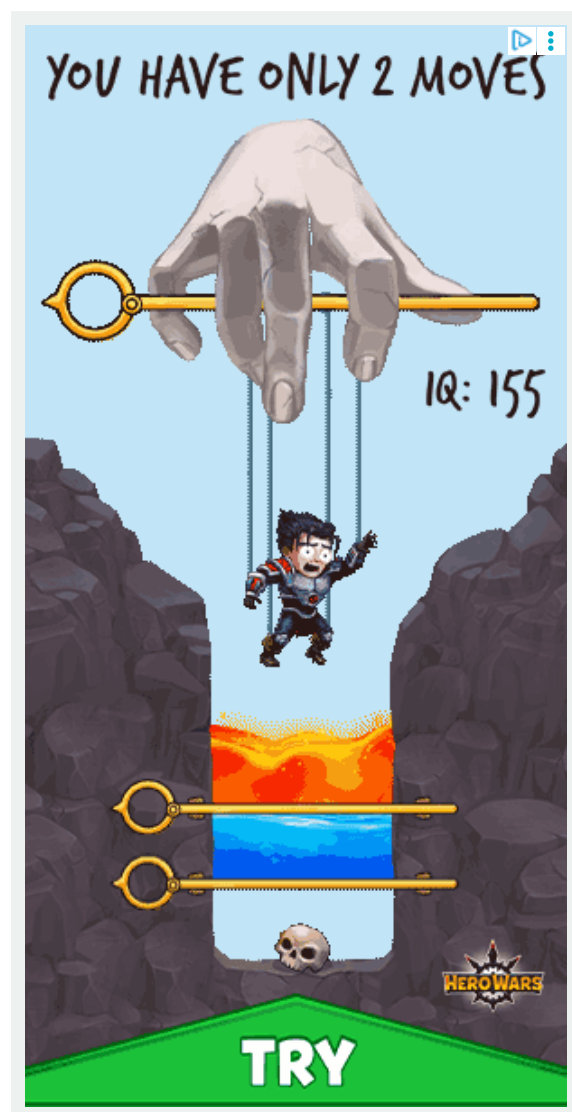
Meanwhile, Jenny Zi will become the leader for TikTok Live.

The reorganization comes as President Trump extended the TikTok shutdown deadline for a third time last month. The [current deadline](#) is September 17.



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U.S. Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick said last week that [TikTok will go dark](#) in the country if China doesn't approve a deal for the sale of the app. Lutnick also stated that the U.S. must control the app's algorithm as part of the sale.

Given the tense situation, which comes in the middle of a tariff war with China, it would not be surprising to see TikTok trying to beef up its USDS team as its U.S. deal hangs in the balance.

“For increased alignment across our robust trust and safety programs, the T&S Product team will now become part of the TikTok Product organization,” Chew wrote. “We are creating a new Platform Responsibility team, which will be led by Adam Wang, reporting to Fiona Zhi. Adam has successfully led the launch and expansion of TikTok LIVE globally over the past four years.”

“I am confident that this reorganization will put us in an even stronger position to match the opportunities ahead of us,” the memo said.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Social](#) [TikTok](#)

**Aisha Malik**

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporter at MobileSyrup. Aisha...

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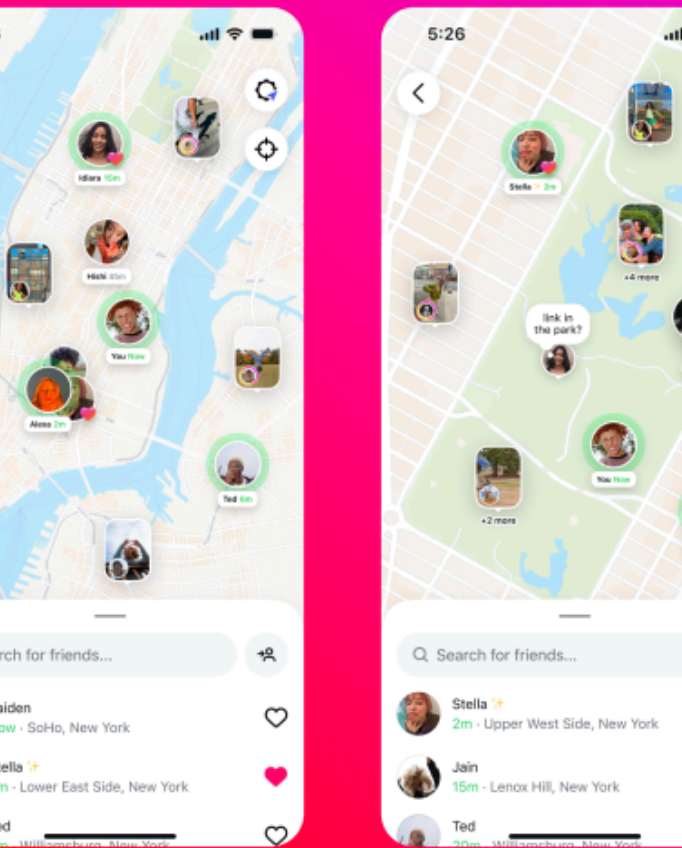


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

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Instagram takes on Snapchat with new ‘Instagram Map’

Aisha Malik — 7:00 AM PDT · August 6, 2025

Instagram is rolling out Instagram Map, a new feature that lets users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content. The Meta-owned social network is also launching reposts, and making its “Friends” tab in Reels available globally.

With its new map feature, Instagram is copying yet another popular feature from Snapchat, after cloning the app’s core Stories functionality [back in 2016](#). Instagram is coming for Snap Map’s crown, a feature that recently surpassed 400 million monthly active users and remains one of the app’s core offerings.

Instagram notes that location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map, and a user’s location only updates when they open the app, meaning it doesn’t provide real-time location updates. Snap Map, on the other hand, allows users to choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

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It's worth noting that Instagram does offer [real-time location sharing via DMs](#) (direct messages). However, unlike Apple's Find My and Snap Map, which let you share your location with others indefinitely, Instagram only lets users do so for up to one hour.

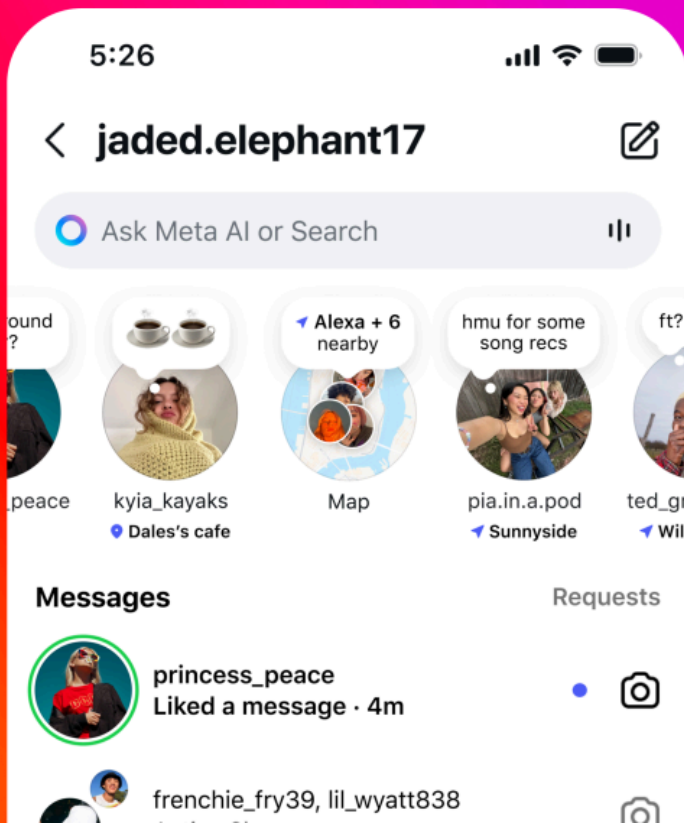


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

Instagram says the new map feature will make it easier for friends to coordinate and link up for hangouts. It also lets users explore location-based content that their friends and favorite creators have shared or engaged with. For example, if your friend attends a nearby music festival and posts a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

Regardless of whether you choose to share your location, you can use the map to explore location-based content, Instagram says.

The map also allows users to leave short messages, or [“Notes,”](#) on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are currently the short messages that appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, users can now post these short updates on the map.

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Although Instagram is certainly taking on Snapchat with this new feature, it also has the opportunity to appeal to people who were fans of [Zenly](#), a social map app that Snap acquired and then shut down in 2023.

The new map feature is launching in the United States starting Wednesday, with broader global availability coming soon. Users can find the Instagram Map at the top of their DM inbox.

The launch doesn't come as a surprise, as [Instagram was spotted developing](#) the map feature last year.



IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

As for the new “Reposts” feature, Instagram is taking a page out of [TikTok’s book](#) while also creating its own version of the popular “retweet” function from Twitter (now X).

This feature lets Instagram users repost public reels and feed posts. These reposts may show up in their friends’ feeds and will also be displayed in a new “Reposts” tab on their profile. Instagram says the new feature gives users a way to share their interests with others and also offers creators the opportunity to reach a wider audience.

To repost a reel or post, users tap the repost icon. Users can also choose to add a note to the repost by typing into the thought bubble that appears on screen and pressing save.

Regarding the new “Friends” tab in Reels, Instagram launched it in the United States earlier this year and is now making it available globally. The tab lets you see public reels that your friends have liked, commented on, reposted, and created.

For users who want to browse and interact with content privately, Instagram is rolling out the ability to opt out of having content you’ve engaged with shown in the friends tab.

Users can hide their likes, comments, and reposts from the tab. Additionally, they can choose to mute likes, comments, and reposts from specific people they follow.

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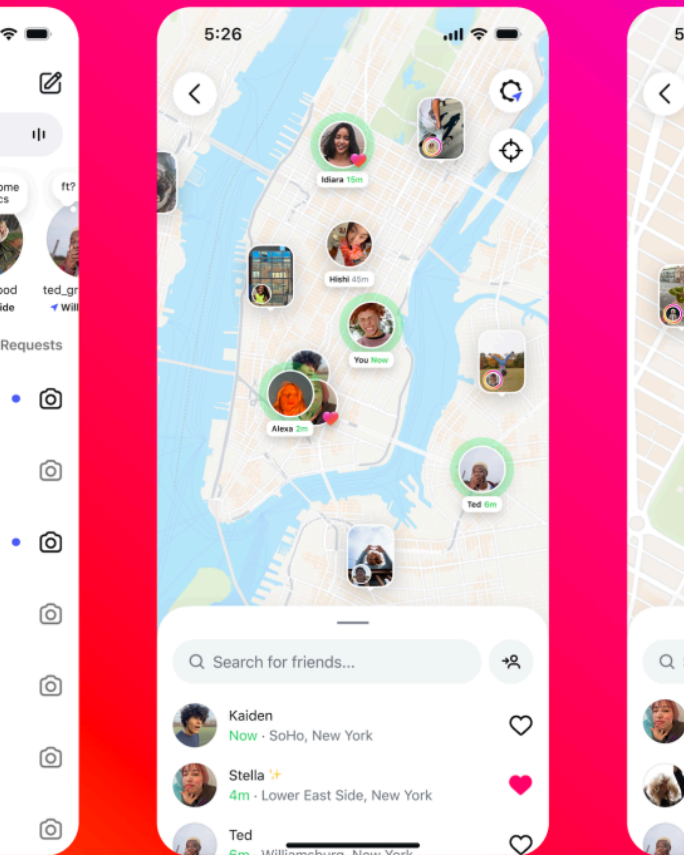
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How to use Instagram Map and set your location-sharing preferences

Aisha Malik — 1:05 PM PDT · August 7, 2025

This week, Instagram introduced a new Snap Map-like feature called [Instagram Map](#) that lets U.S. users share their most recent active location with others and discover location-based content.

IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

If you decide to turn on your location on Instagram Map, your location only updates when you open the app or have it running in the background, meaning it doesn't provide continuous, real-time location updates. This is different from Snap Map, which lets users choose whether their location is updated only when they open the app or in real time.

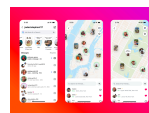
Meta says location sharing is off by default on Instagram Map. Following [concerns](#) around safety, [Instagram head Adam Mosseri](#) reassured users that the feature is opt-in, and noted that some people are "confused" about how the feature works.

For instance, people are accessing the feature and then seeing the map populated with the location information of some users. This is because the feature automatically pulls in location tags from recently posted Stories or Reels that include a tagged location.

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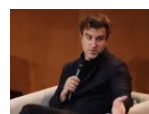
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The backlash against Duolingo going 'AI-first' didn't even matter

Amanda Silberling
- 11 hours ago

It's worth noting that this isn't new, as Instagram already had location tags visible to users in its map view. However, the new Instagram Map feature makes this information a lot easier to access. The new feature might make you rethink whether you want to post your Stories and Reels with location tags (especially if you're still at the location).

For those who want to ensure their location is turned off on Instagram Map, we'll walk you through the steps below.

How to access Instagram Map

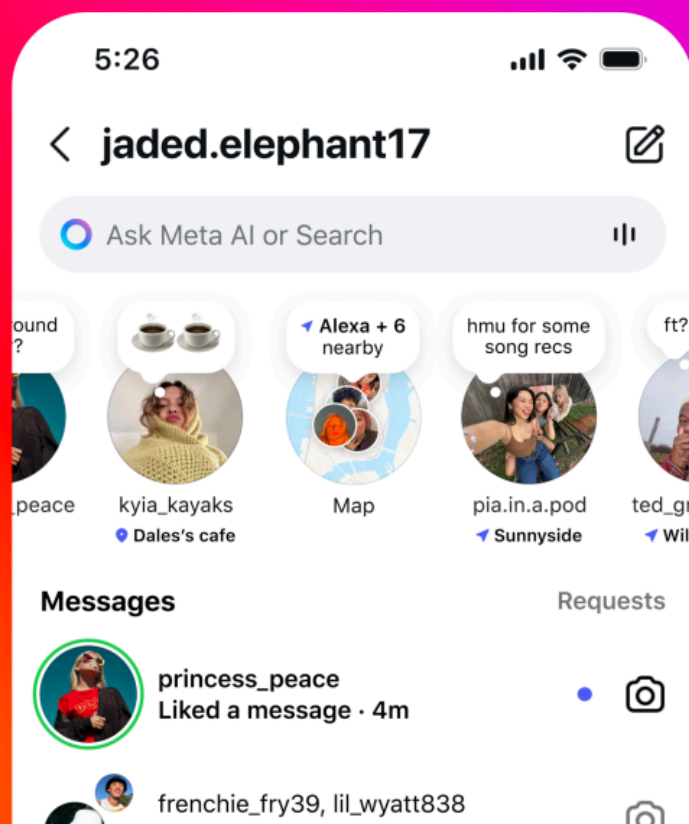


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

To access the new feature, you need to navigate to your DMs page (direct messages) and tap the new “Map” option at the top. If it's your first time accessing the feature, you'll likely see a pop-up message notifying you about the new Map.

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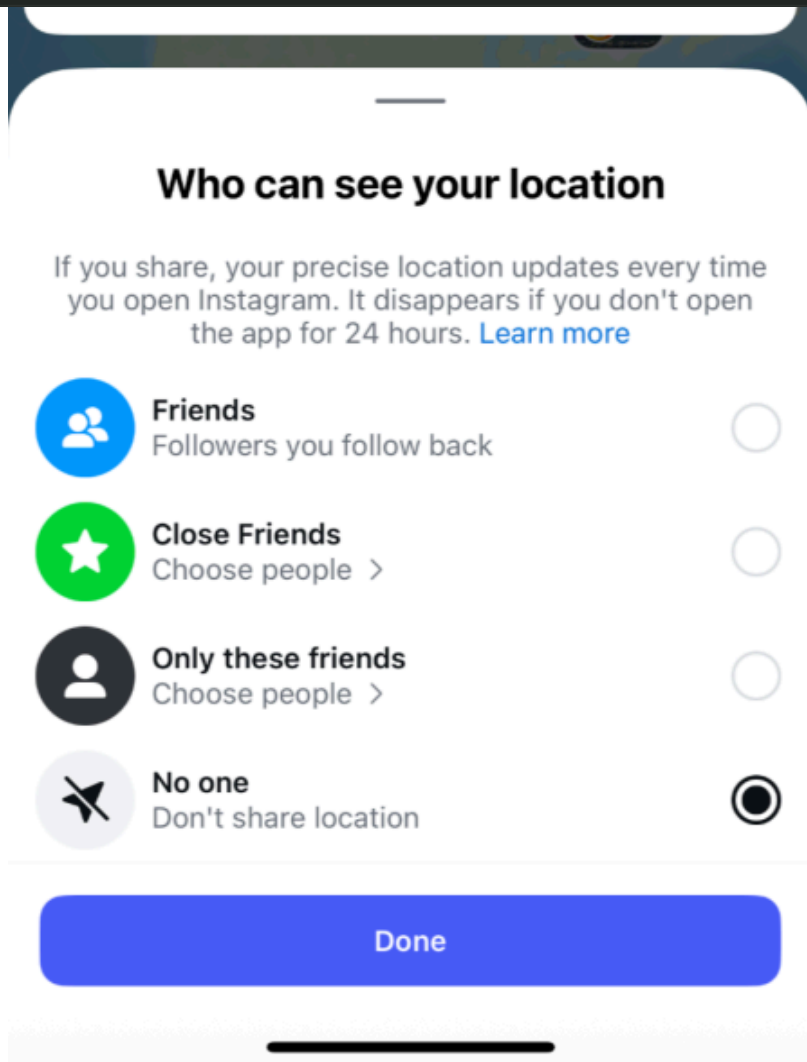


IMAGE CREDITS: INSTAGRAM

The first time you open Map, you will see a page that reads “Who can see your location.” From there, you can choose to share it with your Friends (followers you follow back), your Close Friends list, select users, or no one.

To change your preferences, you need to click on your profile, tap the settings option in the top-right corner, select the “Story, live and location” option, and then tap the “Location sharing” button. Here, you will be able to change your settings.

Note that if you have location sharing turned off, others can still share their location with you, which means you’ll be able to see them on the Map.

How to use Instagram Map

When you open the app, you will see the locations of friends who have shared their location with you. You will also see location-based Stories and Reels from people you follow.

For example, if your friend attended a nearby music festival and posted a story while there, it will appear on the map. Similarly, if a creator you follow posts a reel about a new restaurant in your city, you'll be able to discover it on Instagram Map.

You will still see location-based content on the Map even if you have your location turned off.

You also can leave short, ephemeral messages, or “Notes,” on the map for others to see. Instagram Notes are the short messages that currently appear at the top of your direct messaging feed, but with the launch of Instagram Map, you will now see these posts on the map if they're shared with a location.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

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The backlash against Duolingo going 'AI-first' didn't even matter

Amanda Silberling — 8:32 AM PDT · August 7, 2025

Duolingo [announced](#) on Wednesday that it beat its quarterly revenue estimates, even though the company faced widespread backlash for choosing to embrace generative AI over human workers. Duolingo stock rose [almost 30%](#) on the news.

IMAGE CREDITS: [DUOLINGO](#)

In April, CEO Luis von Ahn [shared](#) that Duolingo would become an "AI-first" company, phasing out its use of contract workers. He also discouraged teams from hiring more employees, unless the team is unable to automate more of its work. With the use of generative AI, Duolingo introduced 148 new language courses, more than doubling its previous offerings.

"Without AI, it would take us decades to scale our content to more learners," von Ahn wrote at the time. "We owe it to our learners to get them this content ASAP."

While some Duolingo users have argued that these AI features are making the app worse, the company's financial metrics tell a different story. Now the company [anticipates](#) making over \$1 billion in revenue this year, and daily active users have grown 40% year-over-year. The growth is significant but falls in the lower range of the company's estimates of growing between 40% and 45%, which an



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investor brought up to von Ahn on Wednesday’s quarterly earnings call.

“The reason we came [in] towards the lower end was because I said some stuff about AI, and I didn’t give enough context. Because of that, we got some backlash on social media,” von Ahn said. “The most important thing is we wanted to make the sentiment on our social media positive. We stopped posting edgy posts and started posting things that would get our sentiment more positive. That has worked.”

On TikTok, the top comments on Duolingo’s videos often remain criticisms of the company’s AI approach. Snarky commenters will ask if videos with multiple people in them are made with AI, to which Duolingo will reply, “Nope. Made by our great team!”

But even if public sentiment toward Duolingo has shifted, its bottom line has not ... and from the company’s perspective, that’s what matters.

Topics: [AI](#) [Apps](#) [duolingo](#)



Amanda Silberling

Senior Writer | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [in](#)

Amanda Silberling is a senior writer at TechCrunch covering the intersection of technology and culture. She has also written for...

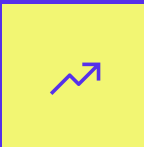
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